

SAP & ERP FOUNDATIONS

Week 1 Question Bank — Daily Practice Set

ERP Thinking & Business Context — All Tracks (Foundation)

Track	SAP Basis / Cloud Engineering Roadmap — Week 1
Topics Covered	ERP fundamentals, data silos, SAP module map, industry research, ECC vs S/4HANA, GitHub portfolio, LinkedIn branding
Format per Day	10 Beginner + 5 Intermediate + 3 Scenario + 2 Mock Interview = 20 Qs
Total Questions	140 questions across 7 days
Purpose	Answer these in a Word document to lock in Week 1 concepts before moving to Week 2

How to use this set:

Go through each day's questions in order. Beginner questions check recall of definitions and facts. Intermediate questions test understanding of relationships between concepts. Scenario questions force you to apply the concept to a real manufacturing/automobile business situation — the same way an SAP Basis or Cloud interviewer would frame it. Mock Interview questions are phrased exactly as a recruiter would ask them live, so practice answering out loud in under 90 seconds before writing them down.

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MONDAY

What is ERP, Really? — ERP concept, the Toyota silo example, erp-explained.md

Beginner Questions (10)

1. What does the acronym ERP stand for?
2. In one sentence, what problem does an ERP system solve for a company?
3. Name the five departments mentioned in the Toyota pre-SAP example and the tool each one used.
4. How many days did month-end reconciliation take before SAP at Toyota? How many days after?
5. What is a 'system of record', and why does a company want only one for each type of data?
6. What does it mean for data to be entered 'once' in an ERP system versus multiple times in separate tools?
7. Name two non-SAP ERP systems you have heard of (e.g., Oracle, Microsoft Dynamics).
8. What is the difference between an ERP system and a single-purpose tool like Excel?
9. Why is real-time data important for a company the size of Toyota or Volkswagen?
10. What does 'integrated' mean when describing how ERP modules talk to each other?

Intermediate Questions (5)

1. Explain why reconciling data across 4 disconnected systems (Excel, DOS app, Oracle Financials, PeopleSoft) takes longer than reconciling data in one ERP system.
2. If a company adds a 6th department next year, what is harder: adding it to a single ERP system or adding a 6th specialised tool to the existing 5? Explain your reasoning.
3. What business risks come from manual data re-entry between disconnected systems (e.g., procurement data being retyped into finance)?
4. How does single-source-of-truth data improve decision-making speed for a manufacturing company's leadership team?
5. Why might a small 10-person company NOT need an ERP system yet, while a 5,000-person automobile manufacturer does?

Scenario Questions (3)

1. A car manufacturer's warehouse team marks 500 units of steel as received, but Finance still shows the purchase order as 'pending' three days later. Using what you learned about data silos, explain why this discrepancy happens without ERP and how SAP would prevent it.
2. You are asked by a non-technical plant manager: 'Why are we spending millions of dollars migrating to SAP when our current Excel-based system works fine?' Write a 4-5 sentence answer using the Toyota reconciliation example.

3. A company has just acquired a smaller supplier and needs to bring their inventory, vendor, and payroll data into the parent company's systems within 60 days. Explain how having one ERP system (versus 5 separate tools) changes the difficulty of this integration.

Mock Interview Questions (2)

1. Interviewer: 'In your own words, explain what ERP is to someone who has never worked in IT or business.' Answer as if speaking out loud.

2. Interviewer: 'Give me a real example of a company that struggled with disconnected systems and how an ERP fixed it.' Answer using the Toyota case.

TUESDAY

The Data Silo Problem — Process-to-module mapping & data flow in S/4HANA

Beginner Questions (10)

1. Which SAP module owns the activity 'Buying steel'?
2. Which SAP module owns the activity 'Hiring an employee'?
3. Which SAP module owns the activity 'Paying a vendor'?
4. Which SAP module owns the activity 'Selling a car'?
5. Which SAP module owns the activity 'Closing the books' at month-end?
6. What does S/4HANA stand for at a high level (SAP Business Suite 4 / Hana database)?
7. What is a 'data silo' in plain English?
8. What is the name of the SAP Help Portal resource used to learn about the S/4HANA product overview?
9. What is the difference between a business process and a business department?
10. Why would a single business activity like 'selling a car' touch more than one module (e.g., SD and FI)?

Intermediate Questions (5)

1. Trace the data flow for a single car sale: which module records the sales order, which module checks inventory, and which module records the revenue?
2. Explain how a Purchase Order created in MM eventually creates an entry in FI without anyone manually re-typing the amount.
3. Why does SAP organize modules around business functions (MM, SD, FI) instead of organizing everything into one undivided database table?
4. What goes wrong operationally if the HR/HCM data for a new hire is not connected to the Finance/FI payroll data?
5. Describe, in your own words, how 'closing the books' in CO depends on accurate data being posted earlier in MM and SD during the month.

Scenario Questions (3)

1. A car factory's procurement team buys \$2M worth of steel (MM), but the Finance team (FI) was never notified and budgeted for only \$1.5M. Explain how this happens in a siloed system and how integrated SAP modules would have prevented it.
2. You are mapping a 'hire to retire' employee journey at a manufacturing company. List the SAP modules involved from the day someone is hired to the day they are paid for the first time, and explain why each module is needed.

3. A regional sales office sells 200 cars in one day (SD) but the warehouse (MM/WM) was not updated and ships only 150. Explain, using the data-silo concept, what likely failed and what an integrated SAP system does differently.

Mock Interview Questions (2)

1. Interviewer: 'Walk me through how data flows from a sales order to financial close in an SAP system.' Give a structured, module-by-module answer.
2. Interviewer: 'Why do companies organize ERP systems by module like MM, SD, and FI instead of one big database?' Answer as if explaining to a hiring manager.

WEDNESDAY

SAP Module Map — FI, CO, MM, SD, PP, QM, PM, HCM, WM, PS

Beginner Questions (10)

1. What does FI stand for and what business function does it cover?
2. What does CO stand for and what business function does it cover?
3. What does MM stand for and what business function does it cover?
4. What does SD stand for and what business function does it cover?
5. What does PP stand for and what business function does it cover?
6. What does QM stand for and what business function does it cover?
7. What does PM stand for (in the SAP module context) and what business function does it cover?
8. What does HCM stand for and what business function does it cover?
9. What does WM stand for and what business function does it cover?
10. What does PS stand for and what business function does it cover?

Intermediate Questions (5)

1. Give one manufacturing example for FI and one for CO, and explain the difference between the two modules even though both deal with money.
2. Explain the difference between MM (Materials Management) and WM (Warehouse Management) — why are they separate modules?
3. Give a manufacturing example of how QM (Quality Management) would interact with PP (Production Planning) on a car assembly line.
4. Give a manufacturing example of how PM (Plant Maintenance) prevents a production stoppage in PP.
5. Explain when a manufacturing company would use PS (Project System) instead of standard PP for production.

Scenario Questions (3)

1. A car factory is building a brand-new assembly line as a one-time capital project costing \$50M, tracked with milestones and budgets. Which module would manage this, and why not PP?
2. A batch of brake pads fails inspection mid-production. Walk through which modules (QM, PP, MM) get triggered and what each one does in response.
3. A robotic welding machine on the assembly line breaks down unexpectedly. Explain which module logs the breakdown, which module schedules the repair, and which module is affected by the resulting production delay.

Mock Interview Questions (2)

1. Interviewer: 'Can you list the core SAP modules and briefly explain what each one does?' Answer as a structured list, the way you would in an interview.
2. Interviewer: 'Which SAP module would you, as a future SAP Basis/Cloud Engineer, work with the most, and why?' Give a thoughtful answer connecting to your career goal.

THURSDAY

Industry Research Deep Dive — Toyota, Volkswagen, Tata Motors annual reports

Beginner Questions (10)

1. Name the three companies researched this week and their home countries.
2. What document type did you search to find SAP mentions for each company?
3. What is S/4HANA, in one sentence?
4. What is SAP HANA, and how is it different from S/4HANA?
5. What is SuccessFactors used for?
6. What does SAP IBP stand for (Integrated Business Planning)?
7. Why would a company mention 'SAP' in its annual report to investors at all?
8. What does it mean when a company says it is 'migrating to S/4HANA'?
9. Name one reason an automobile company would invest in SAP technology according to its strategy.
10. What is the purpose of doing this kind of research before a job interview?

Intermediate Questions (5)

1. Compare how two of the three companies (Toyota, VW, Tata Motors) describe their use of SAP differently in their reports.
2. Why might a global automobile manufacturer prioritize SAP IBP (planning) over other modules in its public strategy statements?
3. Explain how mentioning 'SAP HANA' versus 'S/4HANA' in an annual report signals two different stages of technology adoption.
4. Why would a manufacturing company highlight SuccessFactors (HR cloud) in an annual report aimed at investors, who usually care about finance?
5. What does it tell you about an industry's digital maturity if multiple competing automakers are all investing in S/4HANA migrations?

Scenario Questions (3)

1. You find that Volkswagen's annual report mentions an S/4HANA migration timeline of 3 years across 40 plants. Explain, in business terms, why such a migration takes years rather than weeks.
2. An interviewer asks why you want to work in the automobile/manufacturing industry specifically rather than retail or banking. Using your research on Toyota, VW, and Tata Motors, construct a 3-4 sentence answer.

3. Tata Motors' report mentions SAP IBP for supply chain planning during a global semiconductor shortage. Explain how integrated business planning software helps a company respond to a supply shortage faster than spreadsheets would.

Mock Interview Questions (2)

- 1.** Interviewer: 'Why do you want to work in the automobile and manufacturing industry?' Answer using evidence from your research on real companies.
- 2.** Interviewer: 'Can you give an example of a real company using SAP S/4HANA and explain why they made that move?' Answer with a specific company and reason.

FRIDAY

ECC vs S/4HANA Comparison — Database, Data Model, UI, Aggregates, Deployment, Migration

Beginner Questions (10)

1. What does ECC stand for (ERP Central Component)?
2. What database does classic SAP ECC typically run on (any traditional RDBMS, e.g. Oracle/DB2)?
3. What database does S/4HANA run on?
4. What does 'in-memory database' mean in simple terms?
5. What is the name of the modern SAP user interface used in S/4HANA (Fiori)?
6. What was the older, more traditional SAP user interface called (SAP GUI)?
7. What is a 'data model' in the context of a database?
8. Name the three migration approaches: Greenfield, Brownfield, and Selective Data Transition.
9. What does 'Greenfield' migration mean in one sentence?
10. What does 'Brownfield' migration mean in one sentence?

Intermediate Questions (5)

1. Explain why S/4HANA's simplified data model needs fewer 'aggregate tables' than ECC's data model.
2. Why is SAP Fiori considered more user-friendly than the classic SAP GUI, especially on mobile devices?
3. Explain the business trade-off between choosing Greenfield (rebuild from scratch) versus Brownfield (convert existing system) during a migration.
4. What does 'Selective Data Transition' offer that neither pure Greenfield nor pure Brownfield offers?
5. Why does an in-memory, columnar database like HANA make real-time reporting faster than older row-based databases?

Scenario Questions (3)

1. A 20-year-old SAP ECC system has heavy customizations that the business depends on, but the data model is messy. Which migration approach (Greenfield, Brownfield, or Selective Data Transition) would you recommend, and why?
2. A company wants to keep its historical financial data exactly as-is but redesign its production planning processes from scratch during an S/4HANA move. Which migration approach fits, and why?
3. Explain to a CFO who is worried about cost and downtime why moving from ECC to S/4HANA on HANA's in-memory database could justify the investment through faster month-end close.

Mock Interview Questions (2)

1. Interviewer: 'What are the key differences between SAP ECC and S/4HANA?' Answer covering at least 4 of the 6 comparison rows (database, data model, UI, aggregates, deployment, migration).
2. Interviewer: 'If you were advising a client on migrating from ECC to S/4HANA, how would you decide between Greenfield and Brownfield?' Give a structured answer.

SATURDAY

The ERP Explainer & GitHub Portfolio Setup

Beginner Questions (10)

1. What is the goal of the 1-page ERP explainer you wrote this week?
2. Who is the target audience for the explainer (a smart 16-year-old with no ERP background)?
3. What real-world example did you use to make the explainer concrete (Toyota)?
4. What is the name of your GitHub repository created this week?
5. What four things should a professional README include (name, career goal, target role, skills)?
6. What is a 'README' file used for in a GitHub repository?
7. Why is it useful to commit files like erp-explained.md to GitHub instead of just keeping them on your laptop?
8. What is the difference between a private and a public GitHub repository, and which is better for a portfolio?
9. What does the term 'commit' mean in Git/GitHub?
10. Why should your explainer avoid unexplained jargon if the audience is a non-technical 16-year-old?

Intermediate Questions (5)

1. Explain why writing a complex technical topic in simple language (like your ERP explainer) is actually a useful interview skill.
2. How does a well-organized GitHub portfolio repository help you stand out to a recruiter screening SAP Basis/Cloud candidates?
3. What makes a GitHub README 'professional' versus a basic, unstructured one?
4. Why is it valuable to keep your module map diagram and explainer in the same repository instead of separate, scattered files?
5. How would you structure your GitHub repo folders if you plan to add 11 more weeks of content (Weeks 2-12) to it?

Scenario Questions (3)

1. A recruiter opens your 'SAP-Basis-Portfolio' GitHub repo for the first time and has 30 seconds to decide if you're worth interviewing. Describe exactly what they should see on the README to make a strong first impression.
2. You are asked in an interview to explain ERP to a non-technical stakeholder on the spot. Recreate, from memory, the core structure of your written 1-page explainer in 5-6 sentences.

3. Your GitHub repo currently has 2 files after Week 1. Plan out (in 3-4 sentences) how you would organize folders so that 11 more weeks of SAP content stays clean and navigable for a recruiter.

Mock Interview Questions (2)

1. Interviewer: 'Tell me about a project or piece of writing you're proud of from your self-study.' Use your ERP explainer as the answer.

2. Interviewer: 'How do you keep track of and showcase what you learn outside of class?' Describe your GitHub portfolio habit as your answer.

SUNDAY

LinkedIn Launch & Professional Networking

Beginner Questions (10)

1. What is the exact LinkedIn headline format used this week (CS Student | SAP Basis & Cloud Engineering | Automobile & Manufacturing IT)?
2. How many paragraphs should the LinkedIn About section contain?
3. What should paragraph 1 of the About section cover (CS/DevOps background)?
4. What should paragraph 2 of the About section cover (what you are building)?
5. What should paragraph 3 of the About section cover (what you want / target role)?
6. How many SAP professionals were you asked to connect with this week?
7. What search term was used to find SAP professionals to connect with ('SAP Basis Consultant')?
8. Why does a connection request need a personalised note instead of just clicking 'Connect'?
9. What is the purpose of a LinkedIn headline beyond just your job title?
10. Why is consistency between your GitHub portfolio and your LinkedIn profile important?

Intermediate Questions (5)

1. Explain why a specific, role-targeted LinkedIn headline performs better in recruiter search results than a generic one like 'Student at XYZ University'.
2. Why does structuring your About section into 3 distinct paragraphs (background, current build, goal) make it easier for a recruiter to skim?
3. What is the risk of sending 20 generic, non-personalised connection requests in one day on LinkedIn?
4. How does connecting with 'SAP Basis Consultant' professionals specifically (versus general 'SAP' professionals) target your networking more effectively?
5. Why should your LinkedIn About section mention concrete skills (AWS, Linux, Docker, SAP BTP) instead of vague phrases like 'hardworking and motivated'?

Scenario Questions (3)

1. A recruiter searching LinkedIn for 'SAP Basis intern Lahore' finds your profile. Walk through what your headline, About section, and recent activity should show within the first 10 seconds to make them click 'message'.
2. You send 20 connection requests with the personalised note from this week's plan, but only 3 people accept. Suggest two changes to your approach for next week to improve the response rate.

3. One of your new SAP connections responds and asks 'What are you currently working on?' Write a 2-3 sentence reply that ties together your GitHub portfolio, your Week 1 ERP learning, and your career goal.

Mock Interview Questions (2)

1. Interviewer: 'Tell me about yourself.' Answer using the same structure as your LinkedIn About section (background, current build, goal).
2. Interviewer: 'How do you network and build relationships in the SAP community as a student?' Describe your LinkedIn connection strategy as your answer.